

● CHECKLIST · T-28 TO T+14 · 7 WORKSTREAMS

The Product *Launch* Checklist

Six weeks, day by day: Product Hunt, Show HN, waitlist conversion, press, social, community and email, sequenced so each piece feeds the next. Tags show which workstream owns each task, so you can split it across a small team.

WORKSTREAM TAGS

PH = Product Hunt and launch sites · HN = Hacker News · WL = waitlist · PR = press · SOC = social · COM = community · EM = email · OPS = operations

BEST FOR

Self-serve SaaS, AI apps, dev tools, and Web3 products with a public launch

TEAM

Works with 2 to 4 people; assign one launch owner

INTERACTIVE VERSION

shilikajain.com/tools/marketing-checklist

T-28 to T-22 Decide and set up

- ☐ Launch date set (Tuesday to Thursday), checked against holidays, major conferences and competitor news. **OPS**
- ☐ One launch goal with a number, for example activated users, qualified demos or deposits. **OPS**
- ☐ Run-of-show doc started: every task, owner, due date. **OPS**
- ☐ Launch story written in 3 sentences: what is new, who it is for, why now. **PR**
- ☐ Press approach decided: one exclusive, a small embargo group, or no press. **PR**
- ☐ Waitlist segmented by source and fit, with the highest-fit users flagged for early access. **WL**
- ☐ Product Hunt: decide self-hunt or hunter. Maker accounts for every founder, with photos and bios, active on the platform for weeks before launch. **PH**
- ☐ Community channel set up with rules, roles, welcome flow and anti-scams pinned message. **COM**

T-21 to T-15 Build the assets

- ☐ Landing page live with one call to action, analytics events and UTM tracking verified. **OPS**
- ☐ 60 to 90 second demo video and 4 to 6 product screenshots or GIFs. **SOC**
- ☐ Press kit, release, fact sheet and founder bios drafted. **PR**
- ☐ Media list: 20 to 40 reporters with a recent relevant article each. **PR**
- ☐ Product Hunt draft: name, tagline under 60 characters, description, 4 to 6 gallery images, topics, maker's first comment. **PH**
- ☐ Show HN draft: plain title starting "Show HN:", a first comment explaining what you built, how, and what you want feedback on. **HN**
- ☐ Email sequence written: early-access invite, launch-day email, day 3 use case, day 7 proof. **EM**
- ☐ Founders posting 3 times a week on LinkedIn or X, building context for the launch without spoiling it. **SOC**

T-14 to T-8 Warm up

- ☐ Early access opened to top-fit waitlist users in batches of 50 to 200. Collect feedback and testimonials. **WL**
- ☐ Onboarding fixed based on early-access drop-off points. **OPS**
- ☐ Exclusive offered or embargo pitches sent. **PR**
- ☐ 3 testimonials approved in writing for the landing page and Product Hunt comment. **WL**
- ☐ Partner, investor and advisor amplification kit drafted: copy-paste posts, images, exact time. **SOC**
- ☐ Community AMA or launch-day event scheduled. **COM**

☐ Load test signup, payments and onboarding at 10x normal traffic. **OPS**

T-7 to T-1 Lock and rehearse

☐ Press briefings held; embargo materials sent only to reporters who agreed. **PR**

☐ Product Hunt launch scheduled for 12:01 a.m. Pacific. Gallery checked on mobile. **PH**

☐ Waitlist pre-launch email: "Tomorrow, you get in first," with the exact time. **EM**

☐ Amplification kit sent to partners and investors with the go-live time. **SOC**

☐ War-room channel opened, roles assigned: replies, social, press, support, engineering on call. **OPS**

☐ FAQ and hard-question doc shared with everyone who will reply publicly. **OPS**

☐ Status page and support macros ready. **OPS**

T-0 Launch day

☐ 12:01 a.m. PT: Product Hunt live, maker comment posted. **PH**

☐ Embargo lifts: release and blog published, press page updated. **PR**

☐ Launch email to the full list; waitlist converted with a direct access link. **EM** **WL**

☐ Founder posts on LinkedIn and X with native video; link in first comment on LinkedIn. **SOC**

☐ Show HN posted during US morning, on a different day from Product Hunt if both matter. Founder answers technical questions directly and candidly. **HN**

☐ Community announcement and live AMA. **COM**

☐ Every comment on every platform answered within an hour. **OPS**

☐ Hourly check: signups and activation against goal; fix the biggest drop-off live. **OPS**

☐ Never ask for upvotes on Product Hunt or Hacker News. Ask people to "check it out and share feedback". **PH** **HN**

T+1 to T+7 Sustain

☐ Coverage shared and each reporter thanked individually. **PR**

☐ Second-wave pitches with a new angle: customer story, launch data, founder op-ed. **PR**

☐ Day 3 email: one specific use case with a screenshot. **EM**

☐ Launch-week recap post with the numbers you are comfortable sharing. **SOC**

☐ Cross-post to secondary launch sites and relevant directories. **PH**

☐ Non-activated signups get a personal nudge or onboarding call offer. **EM**

☐ Day 7 email: proof (testimonial or result) plus one feature they probably missed. **EM**

T+8 to T+14 Learn and convert

- ☐ Launch retro: what moved the goal, cost per activated user by source, what to repeat. **OPS**
- ☐ "Featured in" and "as seen on Product Hunt" badges added only where accurate. **SOC**
- ☐ Launch feedback turned into a public changelog entry ("You asked, we shipped"). **COM**
- ☐ Pitch podcasts and newsletters using launch coverage as proof. **PR**
- ☐ AI search check: ask assistants about your category and note if launch coverage is being cited. **PR**
- ☐ Next launch moment scheduled within 6 to 8 weeks. **OPS**

● NEXT STEP

Want a senior operator *on your launch?*

Templates get you organised. Coverage, citations and pipeline come from judgement: which angle a journalist will actually take, which channel deserves the next dollar, and what to cut.

Book a 30-minute teardown. Bring your launch plan, your positioning or your last campaign and leave with a prioritised list of fixes.

Book a 30-minute teardown: shilikajain.com/contact

Six years

PR and go-to-market for Web3, AI and cybersecurity founders.

50+ protocols

Launches, funding rounds and token events supported.

Tier-1 outlets

Forbes, CoinDesk, Cointelegraph, Decrypt, The Block, Blockworks, AI Magazine.

Prefer to self-serve first? Try the free interactive planners, budget calculator and checklist at shilikajain.com/tools. More downloads live at shilikajain.com/resources.

Engagements: fractional PR retainer \$5K to \$12K per month. Launch sprint \$15K to \$40K.